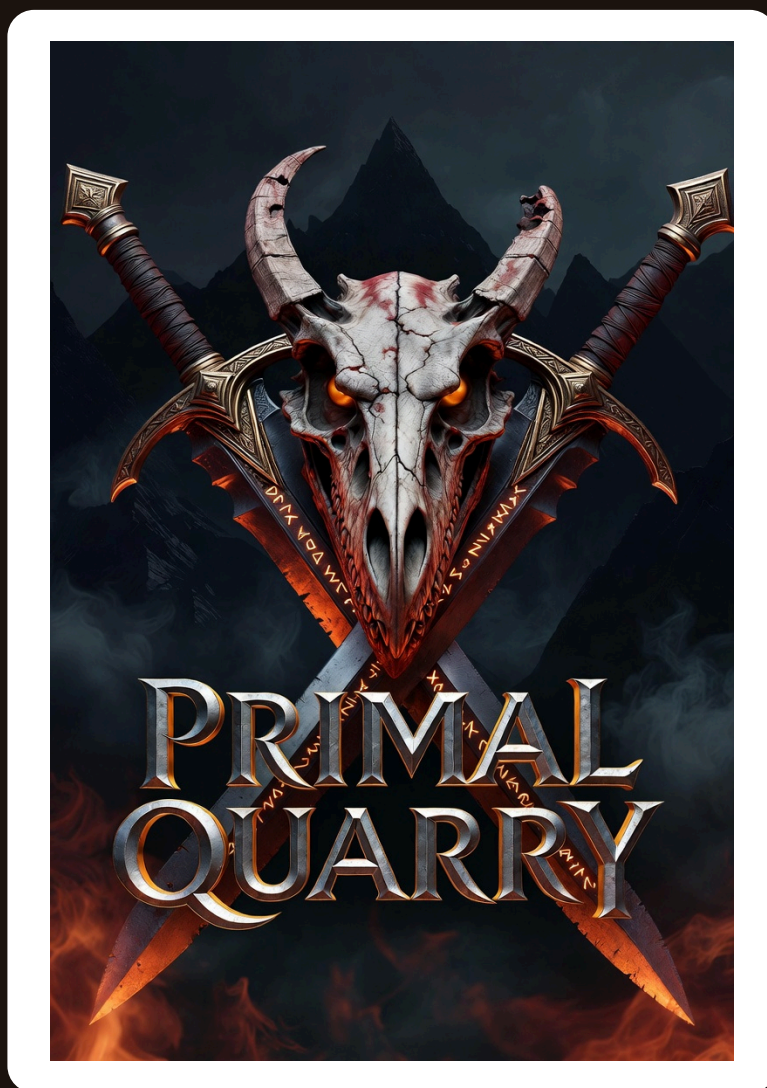




Monster Hunter Rise — Sunbreak

Modded Game Guide & Modlist

Wave 0 · Rookie

Wave 1 · Expedition

Wave 2 · Warden

Game version 16.0.3.1 · Fluffy Manager 5000 · PC (Steam)

“The quarry takes who it takes — and forges the rest.”

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1 Welcome

I 1.1 What This Guide Is

Primal Quarry is a structured, three-wave playthrough framework for **Monster Hunter Rise** with the **Sunbreak** expansion — game version **16.0.3.1**, PC (Steam). It pairs a full how-to-play guide with a curated modlist that is installed through **Fluffy Manager 5000**.

Each wave is a complete new-game setup: a fresh save, a fresh mood, and its own mod subset. The waves are the story of your time at the quarry:

1. **Wave 0 — The Rookie's Oath.** A complete beginner's guide to how Monster Hunter actually works. Mods in this wave are vanilla-plus only: UI and quality-of-life tools that make the game easier to read and operate, never easier to win.
2. **Wave 1 — The Expedition.** Deeper strategy for hunters who know the basics: advanced combat, skills and builds, and the systems Sunbreak adds. Mods here add content and new mechanics — with the hard rule that nothing may be a pure power spike.
3. **Wave 2 — Warden of the Quarry.** Endgame mastery: anomaly investigations, risen monsters, augment crafting, and long-term goals. The philosophy from Wave 1 carries over.

The wave guides are written so that everything you need for **your** wave is in that wave's chapters; earlier chapters teach the fundamentals, later chapters assume them.

1.1.1 What You Need

- **Monster Hunter Rise** plus the **Sunbreak** expansion, updated to the latest 16.x patch (this guide is written against 16.0.3.1).
- **Fluffy Manager 5000** — installed and configured per Part 1, Setup.
- The wave's mod archives — supplied by you, the owner of this list (see Part 2 for the entries).
- One save slot per wave. Rise gives you multiple slots; keep the waves from bleeding into each other.

1.1.2 How to Read Mod Entries

Every mod in this guide is presented as a card with four fields:

- **Dependencies** — other mods or frameworks the mod needs (install those first).
- **System / mechanic impact** — what the mod actually changes in the game.
- **Notes** — load order, configuration, or anything else worth knowing.
- Optionally **Version** — the specific mod release this entry refers to.

The list is curated at the owner's direction — the owner may supply entries, or direct the project to research and add them. Either way, every card records only what is verifiable, never invented.

Note

Wave-specific mods may change mechanics this guide describes. When a mod touches something explained here, its card is the authority — trust the card, and test in-game after installing.

1.1.3 Housekeeping Rules

- **Back up your saves** before changing mods. Mods modify the game folder, not your save files, but a broken install is far easier to fix when the saves are safe.
- **Re-check the game version** after every game update. A new patch can break mods that were fine the day before; if Steam updates the game, confirm it still reads 16.0.3.1 and re-test your wave's mods.

- **Never enable mods from two waves at once** unless a card explicitly says it is safe. The waves are designed as distinct setups.

I 1.2 Fluffy Manager 5000 — Installation & Configuration

Fluffy Manager 5000 (FM5000) is the mod organizer for this project. It is a free, portable mod manager by **FluffyQuack** for RE Engine Capcom titles — including **Monster Hunter Rise** — and it handles installing, toggling, and reordering mods without you ever touching the game's files by hand.

It manages mods for a game by installing them into a folder the game itself loads as an overlay — for Monster Hunter Rise that is the `nativePC` folder inside the game directory. You never edit that folder yourself; the manager does it.

1.2.1 1. Download & Install the Manager

1. Download the latest **Fluffy Manager 5000** from the official site: fluffyquack.com (the direct download link on the page, `modmanager.zip`).
2. Extract the archive to a normal folder — e.g. `D:\Mods\Fluffy Manager 5000`. Keep it **out** of `Program Files`, `OneDrive`, and any protected folder; it is a portable app and works best somewhere you control.
3. Run `Fluffy.exe`. No installer is needed; the manager writes nothing to the Windows registry.

Tip

Do not extract the manager inside the game's own folder. It needs to live somewhere stable so its per-game data survives game updates.

1.2.2 2. First Launch & Game Setup

1. On first launch the manager shows a list of supported games. Select **Monster Hunter Rise**.
2. If it does not find the install automatically (or you want to double-check), click the game's entry and point it at your game folder — the folder that contains `MonsterHunterRise.exe`: `... \Steam\steamapps\common\MonsterHunterRise\`
3. The manager confirms the game is registered. Your per-game folder now exists inside the manager directory as `Games\MHRISE\`.

Note

Paths inside the manager use `MHRISE` as the game's short name. If your folder is named slightly differently, the manager will create it on first selection — trust what the manager shows you rather than this guide's wording.

1.2.3 3. Where Mods Live

Mods arrive as archives — almost always `.zip`, sometimes `.rar` — that mirror the game's internal folder structure. To add a mod to the manager:

1. Drop the archive into the mods area for the game: `Fluffy Manager 5000\Games\MHRISE\Mods\` (the manager also offers an **Install Mods** button / drag-and-drop in its window).
2. The archive now appears in the mod list. It is **staged**, not yet active.

Note

The manager reads the archive directly; it does not need the archive extracted first, and it keeps your original files untouched. That is what makes uninstalling safe.

1.2.4 4. Installing & Managing Mods

- **Install:** select the mod in the list and click **Install Mod** (or right-click → install). The manager unpacks it into the game's `nativePC` overlay. The list marks installed mods with a green state.
- **Enable / disable:** check the box next to a mod. Disabling removes its files from the overlay without deleting the archive — you can re-enable any time.
- **Reinstall:** if a mod is half-updated or the list state looks wrong, reinstall it from its archive.
- **Uninstall:** right-click → uninstall, or **Purge Mods** to remove everything the manager installed at once. Purge is the safe “reset to vanilla” button.
- **Load order:** drag mods in the list. For mods that overwrite the same files, the one **lower in the list** wins (the later install overwrites the earlier one).

Warning

Install mods that have dependencies **before** the mods that need them. If a card says “requires REFramework (or another dependency)”, that dependency is itself a mod you install the same way, first. See the Dependencies section below.

1.2.5 5. Launching the Game

Use the manager's **Launch game** button. This ensures the current mod list state is applied and starts the game normally. Launching from Steam also works once mods are installed — the files are already in the overlay — but the manager's button is the safest habit.

Tip

After any change to the mod list, launch through the manager at least once. That is the moment a broken mod install announces itself — and with a save backup and a purge, it is always recoverable.

1.2.6 6. Dependencies

Many Monster Hunter Rise mods — especially script-based ones — list a dependency such as **REFramework** on their page. Rules:

- Treat every dependency the owner recorded in a mod's card as mandatory. Install dependencies first, then the mod.
- Dependencies are mods too and go through the exact same install flow (including REFramework, whose archive contains a `dinput8.dll` that lands in the game's main folder).
- A mod whose dependency is missing will silently do nothing — no crash, no error. If a mod “doesn't work,” check dependencies first.

1.2.7 7. Keeping Everything Current

- **Game updates:** when Steam updates Monster Hunter Rise, re-check the version at the main menu. This guide targets 16.0.3.1. After a game update, mods can break even if they were fine the day before — re-test your wave before playing on.
- **Manager updates:** FM5000 checks for updates at launch; update when prompted. Manager updates rarely affect installed mods, but re-verify your list after one.
- **Mod versions:** the owner records version/date info on each card when known. Use it as the compatibility signal — never assume an old mod works on a new patch.

1.2.8 8. Uninstalling Everything

1. In the manager: uninstall each mod (or **Purge Mods**) to restore the game to vanilla.
2. Delete the manager folder. Nothing else needs cleaning — the manager never touches your save games.

Warning

Save games are never modified by mods, but **always** back them up before large mod changes. Saves live under your user profile, outside the game folder: `...\Steam\userdata\<id>\1446780\` is where Rise keeps them (the game's Steam App ID). Copy the folder, don't trust Steam Cloud alone.

1.2.9 9. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
Game not detected at first launch	Manager searched the wrong drive	Re-add the game and point at the folder containing <code>MonsterHunterRise.exe</code>
Mod does not appear in the list	Wrong mods folder, or archive is corrupt	Move the archive into <code>Games\MHRISE\Mods\</code> ; re-download if corrupt
Mod is installed but has no effect	Missing dependency; wrong game version; or the mod needs config	Check the card's dependencies; confirm version 16.0.3.1; read the mod's own instructions
Game fails to start after installing	One bad mod in the overlay	Disable the newest mods one by one; if desperate, Purge Mods and reinstall the wave's mods in order
Manager or game blocked by antivirus	Portable executables get flagged	Add exceptions for the manager folder and the game folder
Mod list state lost	Antivirus or manual deletion of <code>nativePC</code>	Reinstall from the archives — the archives are the source of truth

Note

If the list state ever disagrees with reality, the archives in `Games\MHRISE\Mods\` are the source of truth: purge, then reinstall the wave's mods in dependency order.

2 The Modlist

I 2.1 How the Modlist Works

The modlist is **the owner's list**. Entries are added only at the owner's direction — and when the owner asks the project to research mods (as it did for Wave 0's UI/UX + graphics focus), every entry is a real, verifiable mod with a real link; nothing is ever invented. This chapter defines the rules the list plays by and shows exactly how an entry is written.

2.1.1 Wave Rules

Each wave has its own mod philosophy, and it is a hard rule:

- **Wave 0 — vanilla + UI/QoL only.** Wave 0 mods exist to make the game easier to **see**, easier to **operate**, or easier to **plan**. Nothing in this wave may change combat balance, damage, monster stats, drops, or any gameplay value.
- **Waves 1 and 2 — content + mechanics, no pure power spikes.** A mod is welcome here if it adds content (new monsters, moves, areas, equipment paths, difficulty variants) or new mechanics, or changes systems in a way that creates decisions or trade-offs. A mod is **not** welcome if it is a pure power spike: it simply makes the hunter stronger (more damage, more health, better drops) with no new content, no new mechanics, and no cost.

Note

"No pure power spikes" does not mean "no strong mods" — it means strength must arrive **through** content or mechanics, not instead of them. When a card is ambiguous, the owner decides.

2.1.2 Compatibility Target

Everything in this list targets game version **16.0.3.1** (latest 16.x patch on PC/Steam). The owner records version or release-date information on each card when available; per project rule, that information is used as the compatibility heuristic against the target — the project itself performs no verification.

2.1.3 Conflicts

If two mods collide (they overwrite the same files, or must never be enabled together), the resolution is recorded in `conflicts-mods.md` — a user-owned note file that is **not** included in this PDF. Load-order fixes are applied in Fluffy Manager 5000 (lower in the list wins) and noted on the affected cards.

2.1.4 Current State

Wave 0 is populated (UI/UX + graphics). Waves 1 and 2 below still contain templates only — their entries await the owner's direction.

I 2.2 Wave 0 — Foundations (Vanilla + UI/QoL)

Wave 0 is the beginner's wave: the game plays vanilla, with mods that only make it easier to **see**, **operate**, and **plan**. This wave's focus is **UI/UX and graphics** — cleaner information, a tidier HUD, and a sharper, better-graded picture. Nothing here touches combat balance.

2.2.1 Rules for This Wave

- **UI, QoL & visuals only.** Mods may change the interface, the camera, inventory ergonomics, information display, post-processing/color, or performance. They may not change combat balance, monster behavior, drops, or any gameplay value.
- Anything that alters gameplay stats or mechanics belongs to Wave 1+ and must clear the power-spike gate there.

2.2.2 Frameworks (install first)

REFramework

Dependencies: None — this is the base layer

System / mechanic impact: Modding framework with a Lua scripting API. Required by nearly every script/UI mod in this list. Also bundles FOV control, FreeCam (photo mode), and fixes for ReShade/DLL crashes.

Notes: Install before anything else; place in the game root (dinput8.dll).

Custom In-Game Mod Menu API

Dependencies: REFramework

System / mechanic impact: Adds a dedicated 'Mods' section to the in-game Options menu, so compatible mods expose their settings natively instead of only through the REFramework overlay.

Notes: Install after REFramework and before any mod that lists it as a dependency.

2.2.3 UI & UX

Adjustable UI Scale

Version: 3.2

Dependencies: REFramework (V1.1.1+); Custom In-Game Mod Menu API optional

System / mechanic impact: Scales the game's oversized HUD elements (quest UI, radial menu, names, and more) down so the screen reads clean instead of cluttered. Display-only — no gameplay values change.

Notes: Installs to reframework/autorun/UI_Scaler.lua; per-element scale is tuned in-game.

Better Matchmaking

Dependencies: REFramework; Custom In-Game Mod Menu API optional

System / mechanic impact: Removes the 60-second lobby-search timeout, disables region locking, and drops the language filter so online matchmaking searches globally.

Notes: Online QoL only — no combat or balance change.

Adjustable Damage Number Size

Dependencies: REFramework

System / mechanic impact: Resizes and restyles floating damage numbers for better combat readability. Cosmetic display only.

Notes: Pairs well with Adjustable UI Scale for a cleaner HUD overall.

Alphabetized Skill Lists

Version: 1.1

Dependencies: REFramework

System / mechanic impact: Sorts the pick-a-skill lists (smithy and equipment menus) alphabetically, making set-building noticeably faster.

Improved Skill Notifications

Version: 0.1.0-beta1

Dependencies: REFramework; Custom In-Game Mod Menu API (highly recommended)

System / mechanic impact: Adds on-screen activation/inactivation notifications for skills that normally give no feedback (Agitator, Peak Performance, Resentment, and others).

Notes: Beta build — expect rough edges.

2.2.4 Graphics & Visuals

ReShade

Dependencies: None — standalone injector installed onto MonsterHunterRise.exe

System / mechanic impact: Post-processing injector for color grading, sharpening, tonemapping, and ambient occlusion. Tones down the base game's bright, saturated palette for a more grounded look.

Notes: Run in DirectX 11 (-dx11) for best compatibility. Community-recommended preset .ini files (e.g. 'Embers', 'Nyx Realism') are published on Nexus — load one from the in-game ReShade menu (Home key).

Note

Wave 0's QoL base is the one layer that stays relevant in every later wave. If a Wave 0 mod proves essential, the owner may keep it enabled across waves — note that on the card.

I 2.3 Wave 1 — The Expedition (Content + Mechanics)

Wave 1 opens the door: new content and new mechanics are welcome, as long as nothing is a **pure power spike** — strength must arrive through content, mechanics, or trade-offs, never instead of them.

Wave 1 modlist — owner input required

Pending owner input. These entries are added only at the owner's direction — the owner may supply them, or direct the project to research them (as it did for Wave 0).

2.3.1 Rules for This Wave

- **Content + mechanics welcome:** new monsters, moves, equipment paths, areas, difficulty variants, or system changes that create decisions.
- **No pure power spikes:** a mod that only makes the hunter stronger — raw stat bumps, free buffs, boosted drops — with no new content, mechanic, or cost does not belong in this wave.
- Anything borderline is the owner's call; record the reasoning on the card.

Note

If a Wave 1 mod changes something the Wave 1 guide chapters describe, the card is the authority — re-read it whenever the guide and the game disagree.

I 2.4 Wave 2 — Warden of the Quarry (Endgame Depth)

Wave 2 is the endgame wave: the deepest content and the richest mechanics the owner wants in this list. The Wave 1 rule carries over in full — no pure power spikes.

Wave 2 modlist — owner input required

Pending owner input. These entries are added only at the owner's direction — the owner may supply them, or direct the project to research them (as it did for Wave 0).

2.4.1 Rules for This Wave

- The same gate as Wave 1: content and mechanics yes, pure power spikes no.
- Endgame-appropriate additions (deeper endgame content, more challenging hunts, richer progression) are exactly what this wave is for.
- As always: anything that only inflates numbers without adding content, mechanics, or decisions is out.

Note

Wave 2 rides on top of Wave 0's QoL base; the owner may also carry forward selected Wave 1 mods. Note any cross-wave dependencies on the cards.

3 Wave 0 — The Rookie's Oath

3.1 The Rookie's Oath

Wave 0 — The Rookie's Oath

The Primal Quarry is an old name — a terraced hunting ground carved into the cliffs above Kamura Village, where generations of hunters have been forged. Its lower terraces are gentle: forest paths, flooded hollows, a shrine wrapped in mist. Its deepest tiers are not gentle at all.

*The Guild keeps the quarry stocked with young hunters the way a forge keeps its fire fed, and every rookie who takes the oath begins the same way — with a weapon they barely understand, a palico that knows better than they do, and a promise: **learn, or be learned.***

This wave is that promise. No exotic tools, no shortcuts — just you, your weapon, and the quarry teaching you how to hunt.

3.1.1 Wave 0 Goals

- Learn the full hunting loop: prepare, hunt, harvest, craft, repeat.
- Pick one weapon and learn its moveset properly.
- Clear the Kamura village story and enter High Rank through the Gathering Hub.
- Meet the Rampage — the quarry's first true trial — and survive it.
- Reach the point where Sunbreak's Master Rank begins (Part 4 continues from there).

Note

Wave 0 is deliberately slow. Nothing in this wave's modlist makes you stronger — the improvement has to come from you, and that is the point.

3.2 First Hours in Kamura

Your first session is about orientation, not progress. Kamura Village is small — every facility you need is within a short walk — and learning what each one does is the real first quest.

3.2.1 What You See in the Village

- **Your house** — where your item box, equipment box, and save options live. The item box is your inventory bank; loadouts live here too.
- **The smithy** — forge and upgrade weapons and armor. This is where hunts turn into power.
- **The buddy plaza** — where your palico and palamute are managed, and where Meowcenaries and the Argosy operate (see **Buddies and Town**).
- **The canteen (dango)** — eat before every hunt; see **The Hunt**.
- **The quest counter** — village quests. The Gathering Hub (separate counter) holds multiplayer-scaled hub quests.
- **The training area** — a safe practice room. Use it before you judge a weapon; details in **Combat Basics**.

3.2.2 Character Creation & Saves

Create your character, pick a palico and palamute, and give them names you will not get tired of — they are with you the whole way.

Tip

Use a dedicated save slot for this wave (and separate slots for Waves 1 and 2). The game supports multiple slots; keeping one per wave means the waves never bleed into each other.

3.2.3 Controls

The game ships with sensible defaults for both keyboard + mouse and gamepad, and **every** control is rebindable. Open **Options** → **Controls** and confirm the bindings for these action groups before your first hunt:

Action group	What it does
Move / Camera	Movement and look — the camera is your main tool; keep it comfortable
Attack (primary / special)	Your weapon's two main attacks, plus weapon-specific inputs
Guard / Dodge	The defensive buttons every weapon gets (some block, some roll)
Wirebug actions	Wirebug leaps and Wirefall recovery (see Combat Basics)
Use item / item shortcuts	Potions, whetstones, and your item wheel
Sheathe / Sprint	Weapon sheathing and running (sheathed, you run faster)
Map / Interact	World map, and gathering/interacting with the environment
Mount / Ride	Getting on your palamute and mounting monsters

Note

The exact keys are the defaults shown in your Options menu; this guide deliberately does not list key names, because rebinds are common. What matters is **knowing** each action group's button before a hunt, not matching some printed list.

3.2.4 Recommended Settings

- **Target / focus camera:** enable the focus-camera option and try both lock modes — locking a monster makes early hunts dramatically easier to track.
- **Auto-sheathe:** consider turning it off; controlling when you sheathe matters later.
- **Graphics:** start at a preset your GPU can hold at a stable frame rate (60 fps is ideal). Prefer stable frames over maxed detail — reads and dodges depend on it.
- **Subtitles:** on, if you want the story and NPC instructions written out.
- **Camera speed:** a little above default is usually comfortable; tune in the training area.

3.2.5 Your First Quest

Talk to the quest counter and take the first village quest. It will be gentle — gathering, or a small monster — and that is the point: the game is walking you through the loop one step at a time. Complete it, return, and follow the NPCs' instructions. The village will hand you your first **large monster** hunt soon enough.

Tip

Talk to everyone with a marker. In Monster Hunter, important unlocks are often handed to you by NPCs — quests, tools, and facilities appear by following conversations.

■ 3.3 The Hunt — How a Quest Actually Works

Every hunt runs the same loop. Master the loop and every monster in the game is a variation on it.

3.3.1 1. Prepare

- **Eat dango.** The canteen meal grants stat boosts and a food skill — always eat before a hunt.
- **Check your loadout.** Carry potions, mega potions, a whetstone (melee), and quest-appropriate items (antidotes, nullberries). Save a standard loadout at the item box so preparation is one click.
- **Check the target.** The quest brief shows the monster; the Hunter's Notes (main menu) show its element/status weaknesses once you have researched it.
- **Bring your buddy.** Palamute and palico come along automatically once assigned.

3.3.2 2. Find

When the quest starts you know the monster's area. Monster tracks — footprints, scales, scratches — raise your **tracking level** as you collect them, and the monster's icon appears on the map. If you lose it, gather more tracks, or ride your palamute and search its known area.

Tip

Set a subcamp as soon as you unlock one — it is a fast-travel point that saves minutes every hunt.

3.3.3 3. Fight

The combat fundamentals are in **Combat Basics**. For the loop, what matters is **reading the monster**: it telegraphs every attack with an animation. Your job is to learn which animations mean what, and punish the openings after attacks whiff.

- **Part breaks** — break horns, tails, claws to stagger the monster and earn extra rewards.
- **Exhaustion and limping** — a tired monster drools and rests; a limping monster is near death (the skull icon appears on the minimap once your tracking is high enough).

3.3.4 4. Finish — Kill or Capture

- **Kill:** when it is limping (or the skull icon shows), push the damage. On death, **carve** the body (usually three carves) for materials.
- **Capture:** place a trap (shock or pitfall) while it is weak, then hit it with two **tranq bombs**. Capture ends the hunt immediately and often grants more rewards — it is the efficient finisher.

Warning

A sleeping monster takes huge damage from the first hit. If it flees to sleep and you want the kill, place a bomb, wind up your biggest attack, and let it land — do not tickle it awake.

3.3.5 5. Carting (Failing)

You have three **carts** per quest. Each time you faint, you are carried back to camp and lose one. Three faints — quest failed. Fainting is normal; the only mistake is not learning from it. After a faint you respawn at camp with reduced supplies, so restock from the item box before going back out.

3.3.6 6. Rewards & Repeat

Quest rewards, part-break rewards, and carved/captured materials all flow back to the smithy. Every hunt either makes you stronger (gear), smarter (patterns), or both. That is the loop — and it is the entire game.

3.3.7 Gathering Along the Way

Never run past a node empty-handed:

- **Mining outcrops** give ores for weapons; **bone piles** give bones for armor.
- **Herbs, honey, and plants** refill your consumable crafting (honey is the road to mega potions — always grab it).
- **Endemic life** (spiribirds and more) gives temporary buffs; the colored birds you collect on the way to a monster are free stats. Collect them every hunt.

II 3.4 Combat Basics

3.4.1 The Three Bars

- **Health** — your HP. Potions refill it; getting hit empties it. When it hits zero you cart (see **The Hunt**).
- **Stamina** — spent by sprinting, dodging, and many attacks. Manage it: an exhausted hunter is a dead hunter. Meat/rations restore it.
- **Sharpness (melee)** — weapons dull with use; a dull blade bounces and deals less damage. **Whetstone** restores it, and every sharpness tier (green, blue, white...) is a real damage step. Sharpening takes a moment — do it when the monster is busy, not while it is looking at you. Ranged weapons trade sharpness for **ammo/coatings** — you carry your resource economy instead.

3.4.2 The 14 Weapons

Every weapon is a complete fighting style. Pick the one that clicks, not the “best” one — all are endgame-viable.

Weapon	One-line verdict
Great Sword	Big charged hits; slow, deliberate, devastating punishes. The patience weapon.
Long Sword	Flow and counters; build the spirit gauge, spend it on powerful combo finishers.
Sword & Shield	Fast, flexible, can use items while unsheathed; the friendliest weapon to learn.
Dual Blades	Relentless fast attacks, high element damage; stamina-hungry, very mobile.
Hammer	Blunt, heavy, and the king of stuns; break heads and knock monsters out.
Hunting Horn	The support hammer: buffs allies with melodies while doing respectable blunt damage.
Lance	The wall: best blocking, poke and counter forever; positioning > mobility.
Gunlance	Lance with explosions: block, stab, and shell; shelling ignores hit zones.
Switch Axe	Two forms — axe and sword — with an elemental discharge finisher; aggressive, technical.

Weapon	One-line verdict
Charge Blade	The most complex: charge phials in sword mode, spend them on big axe-mode burst.
Insect Glaive	Aerial combat and a kinsect buddy that collects extracts; very mobile, hard to master.
Light Bowgun	Rapid-fire shots with every ammo type; mobile and safe, high maintenance.
Heavy Bowgun	Stationary artillery; highest raw damage at range, slow to move.
Bow	Mobile ranged combo weapon with charge levels and coatings; high skill ceiling.

3.4.3 The Combat Principles

- **Position over reflexes.** Most deaths come from standing where the attack lands, not from slow reactions. Be on the monster's **side**, not in front of the mouth.
- **Dodge through, or block.** Dodges have invincibility frames at the start; blocks (shield weapons) negate damage but cost stamina or knockback. Learn which attacks you can dodge and which you must block.
- **Hit zones matter.** Damage numbers and bouncing tell you where to hit. Weak spots — often the head — take noticeably more damage. The Hunter's Notes record each monster's weak points.
- **Elements and status.** Monsters resist or fear elements (fire, water, thunder, ice, dragon) and statuses (poison, paralysis, sleep, blast). Matching the weakness is free damage — check the Notes.
- **The monster is a clock.** Every attack has wind-up, active, and recovery frames. The recovery is your opening. Attack during recovery, not during wind-up.

3.4.4 Wirebugs

Wirebugs are Rise's signature tool — silk-like grappling bugs that let you launch yourself around the monster and recover from mistakes:

- **Wirefall:** knocked down? Press the wirebug action to recover instantly and escape the follow-up attack. This single mechanic saves more hunts than any armor skill.
- **Silkbind attacks:** every weapon has special wirebug moves with cooldowns — powerful attacks or utility. Read them in the weapon controls and practice in the training area.
- **Traversal:** wirebug leaps get you up cliffs and across gaps; **Great Wirebugs** in the field launch you across the map.
- You start with two wirebugs (a skill can add a third). Spent wirebugs recharge over time.

3.4.5 Mounting & Wyvern Riding

Attack while airborne (or with wirebug moves) to build the **riding** state. When it triggers, the monster becomes **rideable**: you control it briefly, and its attacks — including slamming it into other monsters — deal enormous damage. In a pinch, riding is both a free damage window and a way to stop an out-of-control monster.

3.4.6 Blights & Status on You

Monsters inflict **blights** (fire, water, thunder, ice) and statuses (poison, paralysis, stun, sleep). Symptoms are in the top-left of the HUD. Nullberries cure blights; cleanser/antidote items cure

poison; getting hit while stunned or paralyzed is fatal — avoid it by not being greedy when the monster is enraged.

3.4.7 The Training Area

Before every weapon switch, spend five minutes in the training area: hit the dummy, try each silkbind move, and learn your dodge. It is the fastest way to go from “button mashing” to “hunting.”

II 3.5 Equipment & Progression

Everything you earn from hunts funnels into one place: the smithy. Understand gear, and the whole game opens up.

3.5.1 Weapons

- **Forge** a new weapon, or **upgrade** an existing one along its tree. Upgrading is the main path — most weapons evolve through several forms.
- Weapons carry: attack, element/status, sharpness (melee), affinity (crit chance), and sometimes decoration slots.
- Two weapons of the same family can diverge — one raw, one elemental — so build for the matchup, not just “the strongest.”
- Sunbreak adds **augment crafting** (Qurio Crafting) that upgrades weapons further — that is Part 5 territory.

3.5.2 Armor

- Armor’s job is defense + **skills**. Every piece carries skill points; collect enough points of a skill and it activates at thresholds.
- **Upgrade armor** with armor spheres at the smithy — defense keeps up with the rank you are fighting. Under-leveled armor is the classic beginner death cause.
- **Sets vs mixed**: full sets are stylish and simple; mixing pieces lets you stack the skills you actually want. Wave 1 covers builds in depth.

3.5.3 Skills (The Real Power)

Skills are where gear becomes strategy. Early standouts that are almost never wasted:

- **Attack Boost** — flat damage; simple, always useful.
- **Weakness Exploit** — crit chance on weak spots; teaches you to aim.
- **Divine Blessing** — chunks incoming damage; the beginner’s best friend.
- **Stun Resistance** — stops the stun death spiral.
- **Evade Window** — more invincibility frames on dodges.
- **Wirebug Whisperer** — more wirebugs to play with.

Every skill has levels; the effect grows at thresholds. Open any piece of armor and the skill list shows exactly what you have.

3.5.4 Decorations & Talismans

- **Decorations** are craftable gems that socket into armor slots. They are how you fine-tune a build: socket the skills you are missing.
- **Talismans** are equipable charms with random skills — obtained through **melding** at the smithy (trade materials for random talismans). Early on, use whatever fits; hunting for **the** talisman is endgame business (Part 5).

3.5.5 Money & Points

- **Zenny** — the currency. Earned from quest rewards; spent at the smithy. Sell spare materials when broke (the game warns you when a material is needed for something).
- **Kamura Points** — a second currency from gathering, subquests, and hunting. Spent at facilities: meal tickets, buddy gear, and trading.

3.5.6 Meals (Dango)

The canteen's dango is a before-every-hunt ritual: stat boosts (health, stamina, attack, defense) plus a **food skill** with a random proc chance. The skill rerolls each meal — if the proc you want does not show, order again.

Tip

Three habits that cover 90% of progression mistakes: eat dango every quest, upgrade armor every few quests, and craft/socket the skill that fixes whatever is killing you — not the skill that looks strongest on paper.

II 3.6 Buddies & the Town

3.6.1 Your Palamute

The palamute is a riding dog that fights alongside you:

- **Riding** — the fastest way across a map; you can use items while mounted.
- **Combat** — it attacks and draws aggro; some weapon moves can be chained off a mounted position.

3.6.2 Your Palico

The palico is a support cat with a **role** that defines its behavior:

Role	What it does
Fighter	Aggressive, high damage
Assist	Sets traps, uses items on you
Defender	Taunts, takes hits, buffs defenses
Healer	Restores your health
Trapper	Captures small monsters, places traps
Gathering	Collects extra materials during hunts

For a beginner, **Healer** or **Assist** smooths the learning curve most; switch roles whenever you like — the role is training, not a permanent choice.

3.6.3 Buddy Gear & Skills

- Craft and upgrade buddy weapons and armor at the smithy (buddy gear shares your material pool).
- Each buddy equips **support moves** (active abilities) and **buddy skills** (passive perks). Read them and tune: a palico with the healing move set is a different animal from a trapper kit.
- Buddy gear also matters in Master Rank — Sunbreak's harder hunts lean on well-equipped buddies.

3.6.4 The Buddy Plaza

- **Meowcenaries** — send buddies out on expeditions; they return with materials on a timer. Free passive income; keep them running.

- **The Argosy** — a trading ship; trade materials for other materials or Kamura Points. Set it to bring what you are currently missing.
- **The Cohoot** — your owl; check its nest regularly for free daily items.

3.6.5 Town Facilities, Summarized

- **Smithy** — weapons, armor, decorations, buddy gear, melding.
- **Canteen** — dango meals.
- **Item box** — inventory, loadouts, item crafting.
- **Quest counter / Gathering Hub** — village and hub quests (see **Quests & Progression**).
- **Training area** — practice.
- **NPCs with markers** — quests and unlocks; talk to everyone.

Tip

The buddy plaza is easy to ignore and quietly valuable: Meowcenaries + Argosy running in the background means you arrive at every smithy visit with extra materials and points you never had to grind for.

II 3.7 Quests & Progression

3.7.1 Quest Types

- **Village quests** — single-player, set in Kamura. They tell the story and teach the game; their star rating climbs as you complete them.
- **Hub quests** — posted at the Gathering Hub, scaled for multiplayer (solo works too, it just takes longer). Hub quests are where **Hunter Rank (HR)** lives: they unlock the real progression.
- **Urgent quests** — quests marked as urgent that gate the next star tier. Clear the urgent to advance.
- **Event quests** — special quests with unique rewards; download/install from the game's event quest list when available.
- **Subquests** — optional checklists (hunt X, gather Y) running alongside your main quest. They pay extra rewards; pick ones matching what you will do anyway.

Tip

Subquests are free rewards. Glance at the checklist before posting a quest and you will finish most of them by accident.

3.7.2 Low Rank → High Rank

- The village story takes you through **Low Rank (LR)** — the tutorial that doubles as a campaign.
- The **Rampage** is High Rank's signature trial: a siege defense of Kamura where you man weapons and walls against waves of monsters. It gates your HR progress — embrace it as a change of pace, not a chore.
- Hub quests climb into **High Rank (HR)**: harder monsters, better materials, and the gear that matters. Hub HR is where base-game Monster Hunter actually starts.

3.7.3 Into Sunbreak (Master Rank)

The **Sunbreak** expansion adds a third tier on top: **Master Rank (MR)**, based in Elgado, with harder monsters and MR-only equipment. Wave 0's job ends at the door to MR — the expedition is Wave 1's story (see Part 4). What you learn here — the loop, your weapon, your habits — is exactly what MR will test.

3.7.4 Multiplayer Basics

- Post a quest with **Join Request** enabled and other hunters can drop in; you can also join others' requests.
- Play politely: wait for everyone at the start, don't steal the host's kills/captures, and let the host decide capture-vs-kill. (Part 5 has the full etiquette.)
- Monster health scales with party size, so hunting with four is faster than soloing — but solo practice is where skill is built.

3.7.5 Progression Summary

Village story (LR) → Hub HR + Rampage → [Sunbreak] Master Rank → Anomaly Investigations (Part 5).

The game will keep handing you the next step; follow the markers, do the urgents, and upgrade gear when a wall appears. If you hit a wall, the answer is almost never “grind more” — it is **armor upgrades, the right element, and learning the pattern.**

II 3.8 Ten Rules for the Rookie

These ten habits carry you further than any build. Read them before your first big hunt; re-read them after your first wall.

1. **Eat dango before every quest.** It is free stats and a free food skill. Forgetting it is the most common avoidable death.
2. **Master one weapon before trying another.** Every weapon is a full game. Pick one, learn it in the training area, and only branch out when hunts feel easy.
3. **Keep your armor upgraded.** Armor spheres are cheap and defense is the difference between carting and surviving. Upgrade before every urgent.
4. **Collect tracks to track.** The monster's icon on the map is a tool, not a guess. If you lose the monster, gather tracks instead of wandering.
5. **Learn to wirefall.** Knocked down? Recover instantly with the wirebug action. It is the single most life-saving input in the game.
6. **Break parts, don't just DPS.** Breaking parts staggers the monster and grants extra rewards — aim for the head, tail, and claws on purpose.
7. **Capture when you can.** Trap + two tranq bombs ends the hunt early with better rewards. It is the efficient, kind finish.
8. **Carry a full item loadout.** Potions, mega potions, whetstone, antidotes — save it as a loadout so it is one button before every quest.
9. **Gather as you run.** Honey, herbs, ores, and spiribirds make every hunt self-funding. Stop treating gathering as a side quest.
10. **Failure is data.** Every cart teaches a tell. The hunters who clear the endgame are not the ones who never fainted — they are the ones who learned from it.

4 Wave 1 — The Expedition

4.1 The Expedition

Wave 1 — The Expedition

*Beyond the quarry's familiar terraces, the old routes open. The expedition sets out from **Elgado**, a stronghold on the cold frontier, where a crimson glow has begun to bleed into the hills — the mark of the **qurio**, a curse that drives monsters into maddened, afflicted states. The rookie who survived the quarry now walks among veterans. New weapons, new techniques, new monsters wearing the affliction like a crown. This wave is not about learning to hunt anymore — it is about learning to hunt **deliberately**: reading the monster before it moves, building for the fight instead of against it, and treating every system in the game as a tool with a purpose.*

*The expedition does not ask you to be stronger. It asks you to be **better**.*

4.1.1 Wave 1 Goals

- Start a fresh save and push into Master Rank — the expansion's full game.
- Master **Switch Skills** and **Scroll Swap** — two loadouts in one hunt.
- Learn to read monsters at the level where you stop trading hits and start dictating them.
- Build sets deliberately: skills, decorations, talismans — the economy of power.
- Learn the Sunbreak systems: followers, afflicted monsters, and the first taste of Qurio Crafting.

4.2 Advanced Combat

Wave 0 taught you the loop. This chapter teaches you to **own** it.

4.2.1 Switch Skills & Scroll Swap

Every weapon has alternate moves — **Switch Skills** — unlocked through quests and requests. In Master Rank you get the real prize: **Scroll Swap**, which lets you carry two complete loadouts (Scrolls Red and Blue) and switch between them mid-hunt.

The power is not “two movesets” — it is **role switching**:

- One scroll for aggression (damage silkbinds, offensive switch skills), one for survival (counters, utility).
- Swap when the monster's state changes — enraged means you want the defensive scroll.
- Some skills trigger effects on swap; learn your weapon's swap bonuses.

Tip

Build both scrolls around the **same weapon** but **different fights**: the monster's enrage state is your cue to swap, not a reminder to panic.

4.2.2 Counters: The Mastery Layer

Every weapon has at least one defensive move that turns an incoming hit into an offense — **counters, guards, parries**:

- Long Sword: foresight-style parries that refill your gauge.
- Lance: guard counters that answer every poke with one of your own.
- Great Sword: shoulder tackle trades your hitbox for super armor.

- Charge Blade: guard-point timing turns blocks into explosive punishes.

The pattern is universal: **read the wind-up, trigger the counter, punish the recovery.**

This is the skill ceiling of the game, and it is learnable — one monster at a time.

4.2.3 Element, Status, Affinity — the Real Damage Math

- **Element** (fire/water/thunder/ice/dragon) adds flat damage per hit on monsters weak to it. Fast weapons (Dual Blades, Sword & Shield, Bow) love element; slow ones prefer raw.
- **Status** (poison/paralysis/sleep/blast) builds a hidden meter; when it procs, the monster suffers the effect. Status weapons are support tools and crowd-control: paralysis is a free beating, sleep is a free bomb wake-up.
- **Affinity** is crit chance; critical hits deal more damage. Skills like **Weakness Exploit** make affinity the highest-value stat in the game — because it rewards exactly the behavior you should already be doing (hitting weak spots).

Note

The in-game Hunter's Notes list every monster's element/status weaknesses per part. Treat it as the reference — this guide deliberately stays out of the numbers game, because the matchup changes every hunt.

4.2.4 Part Breaking as a Strategy

Wave o said “break parts for rewards.” Now break parts **for fight control**:

- **Severable tails** — cut them and the monster loses its tail attacks (and you gain carve materials).
- **Breakable heads** — many monsters' nastiest attacks come from the head; breaking it weakens or disables them.
- **Flinch thresholds** — parts have damage thresholds; hitting them flinches the monster and resets its rhythm. Chain part breaks to keep pressure windows open.

Plan your targeting **before** the hunt: what part do you break first, and with what tool (sever via cutting damage, break via blunt/impact)?

4.2.5 Wyvern Riding as a Weapon

Riding is not a novelty — it is tactical control:

- Ride the **other** monster into your target for massive damage and a knockdown.
- Use the wall slam for the guaranteed down; use the puny aerial finisher when you need positioning instead.
- In multiplayer, a ride is the team's biggest burst window — call it out (or let the auto-call do it) so the team stops and unloads.

4.2.6 Reading Monsters: The Learning Loop

1. **Watch** a monster's moveset in its enrage state first — that is the dangerous version you must survive.
 2. **Map** each attack to a response: dodge-through, block, counter, or punish.
 3. **Exploit** the recovery: the move that almost hits you is the opening you were waiting for.
- This loop — watch, map, exploit — is the entire endgame skill. Monsters only ever add new animations; they never add new rules.

4.3 Skills & Builds

Wave o told you skills exist. This chapter tells you how to **spend** them.

4.3.1 The Economy of Skills

Power in this game is a budget with three accounts:

- **Armor skills** — the points baked into your armor pieces. The foundation.
- **Decoration slots** — sockets you fill with crafted gems. The flexible layer.
- **Talismans** — one equip slot with random skills. The lottery layer.

Every build is: choose the skills you need → find armor that provides most of them → socket the rest → let the talisman close the gap.

4.3.2 Priority Skills, Ranked by Role

Damage core (almost always worth it):

- **Attack Boost** — flat, reliable, never wasted.
- **Weakness Exploit** — crit on weak spots; the single best damage-per-skill-point in the game.
- **Critical Eye** — affinity everywhere; pairs with Weakness Exploit.

Comfort core (the ones that keep you alive and attacking):

- **Evade Window** — more i-frames; transforms dodging from art to habit.
- **Divine Blessing** — damage chunks reduced; the difference between a recovery and a cart.
- **Stun Resistance** — stops the stun-death; cheap and permanently useful.
- **Wirebug Whisperer** — more wirebugs; more escapes, more silkbinds, more fun.
- **Free Meal** — consumables sometimes not consumed; a quiet economy miracle.

Matchup skills: earplugs (roars), element resistance, specific blight immunity — add these **when the monster demands them**, not always.

Tip

A comfortable build that you play well beats a perfect build you play scared. Prioritize the comfort core first, then fill damage.

4.3.3 Decorations: Crafting the Fit

- Decorations are crafted at the smithy from monster materials; each one is a small skill package.
- Socket them where your armor's natural skills fall short.
- As MR armor gains more slots, the decoration layer becomes the whole game — planning your sockets is planning your build.

4.3.4 Talismans & Melding

- **Melding** at the smithy trades materials for random talismans. Use every melding option the game offers; talisman supply is the long grind.
- Early MR: equip whatever has the skills you want, even if the slots are imperfect.
- Endgame: specific melding recipes target rare skills — that hunt belongs to Part 5, but **start hoarding melding materials now**; you will thank yourself at MR 100.

4.3.5 Building a Set, Step by Step

1. Pick the weapon and the fight.
2. Write the skill list: comfort core + damage core + matchup skills.
3. Search armor pieces for those skills; mix sets freely — don't fear mismatched looks (layered armor fixes fashion later).
4. Fill decoration slots with the missing skills.
5. Slot the talisman; adjust until the budget balances.

4.3.6 Layered Armor: Fashion Without the Cost

Layered armor renders cosmetic armor over your real gear. It means your set can look like anything — farm the layered sets you want as a side goal, and never let looks dictate your actual build.

4.4 Sunbreak Systems

Sunbreak is not just harder monsters — it is a second game's worth of systems layered on the base. This chapter is the tour.

4.4.1 Master Rank & Elgado

- **Master Rank (MR)** is the third tier: MR monsters are faster, harder, and drop MR-only materials for MR-only gear. Village and Hub ranks do not carry over — MR is a fresh ladder of quest stars.
- **Elgado** is the new hub: new NPCs, new facilities, new quest lines. Follow the story markers; they guide the unlock order.
- MR gear invalidates HR gear quickly — plan to re-equip as you climb, don't cling to old sets.

4.4.2 Followers

The expansion's gift to solo hunters: **Followers** — named NPCs who join your hunts as AI partners.

- **Follower Quests** unlock followers and let you hunt alongside them.
- Followers are genuinely competent: they heal, trap, and ride; some are exceptional at specific weapons.
- Use follower quests to learn new weapons in a safe environment — you have a team, so mistakes cost less.

Tip

Follower hunts are the best training ground in the game: bring your worst weapon, let the followers carry the pressure, and read the monster at your own pace.

4.4.3 Afflicted Monsters

The **qurio** curse creates **afflicted** monsters — base monsters turned up to eleven:

- Afflicted monsters take reduced damage until you break their **qurio clusters** (the glowing parts). Breaking clusters staggers them and drops special materials.
- Afflicted materials feed the endgame crafting economy (Qurio Crafting, and later Anomaly Quests — Part 5).
- Expect afflicted hunts to feel like **two** monsters: the base fight plus the cluster management minigame.

4.4.4 Qurio Crafting (Weapon Augments)

Qurio Crafting lets you spend afflicted materials to **augment** weapons — rolling bonus stats or skill slots onto them:

- Augments come in flavors: attack, defense, element, slots, skills — each with its own material cost.
- Augmenting is random; you reroll with more materials. Budget accordingly.
- It is the long-tail upgrade path: your endgame weapon is the one you augments into shape over dozens of hunts.

4.4.5 Switch Skill Swap — the Second Loadout (recap)

Unlocked through MR story progression: two scrolls, swap mid-hunt, role-shift between aggression and survival. See **Advanced Combat** for how to weaponize it.

4.4.6 Where This Leaves You

By the end of the Sunbreak story you have: Master Rank gear, afflicted farming, follower friends, and augments on your best weapons. That is the on-ramp to the true endgame — which is exactly what Wave 2 exists to organize.

II 4.5 The Economy — Farming Without Grinding

“Grind” is what it feels like when you do not know the economy. Learn the loops and the game funds itself.

4.5.1 Zenny & Points Loops

- **Zenny:** quest rewards + selling surplus parts. The classic pitfall is never selling because “I might need it” — sell what the smithy does not currently use; the game marks materials needed for a selected craft.
- **Kamura Points:** gathering, subquests, and special rewards. Spent at meal tickets, buddy gear, and trading — treat points as a second wallet, not a hoard.
- **Meowcenaries:** keep expeditions running at all times — they are passive material income with zero effort.
- **Argosy:** configure the trade routes toward whatever the smithy currently needs. It turns “I need three more of this” into “it arrives by itself.”

4.5.2 Endemic Life: The Free Buffs

Spiribirds are the visible ones — collect the color-coded birds on your route for health/stamina/attack/defense. But the ecosystem has more:

- **Toads and environmental traps** — every map has explosive toads, vines, and falls; a monster lured into one is a free knockdown.
- **Stinkmink-style lures** — some endemic life drags monsters to you or away; use them to control the fight’s location.
- Make a **route:** grab birds and useful endemic life on the way to the monster every single hunt. It is free power and free control.

4.5.3 Material Farming, Deliberately

1. Check the Hunter’s Notes: which monster, which part, which break/carve/capture method drops what.
2. Target the **fastest** source, not the most reliable: capture quests are fast, part breaks are targeted, and some materials only come from specific breaks.
3. Run **subquests** and event quests that pay the material you need as a bonus.
4. If a material only drops from a painful fight, that fight is your training target — farming **is** practice.

4.5.4 MR Material Loops

Master Rank materials follow the same rules but multiply the layers: afflicted materials (from clusters), anomaly materials (Part 5), and follower-quest rewards. Keep the passive loops (Meowcenaries, Argosy) pointed at MR materials and the smithy stays stocked without dedicated farming sessions.

Tip

The best anti-grind tool is **variety**: alternate between your target farm and a different monster every few hunts. The game quietly funnels everything you need into the smithy from every direction — as long as you keep playing, the economy keeps feeding you.

4.6 Wave 1 Strategy — Playing Deliberately

Everything in this wave distills to one upgrade: **decide before the hunt, adapt during it.**

4.6.1 Before the Hunt

- **Build for the fight, not the tier.** Check the target's element/status weaknesses and attack patterns; choose weapon element, armor skills, and consumables accordingly. The monster decides your loadout.
- **Carry the right consumables:** antidotes for poison monsters, cleansers for blights, deodorant-free hunting — match the threat list.
- **Eat for the fight:** pick dango skills that counter what the monster does (resistance, stamina, defense) over pure damage when you are learning it.
- **Set your scrolls** (Scroll Swap) with a plan: what does the red scroll do that the blue one does not?

4.6.2 During the Hunt

- **Restock instead of pushing:** tents at camp allow mid-hunt loadout changes. Out of potions and the monster is enraged? Restock. Pride carts more than monsters do.
- **Use the environment:** every map is full of traps, toads, and terrain. A monster slammed into a wall takes more damage than any combo you could land in the same seconds.
- **Ride deliberately:** save the ride for the **other** monster in multi-monster quests, or for the enrage phase you dread.
- **Learn the enrage:** every monster's enrage state is its real fight. Map your responses to the enrage moveset first; the calm phase takes care of itself.

4.6.3 After the Hunt

- **Ask “why” after every cart.** The answer is a tell you misread, a greed window you took, or a skill you lack — each is fixable and each is a level-up.
- **Audit the build once per rank tier:** is the comfort core still adequate? Are the damage skills still worth their slots? MR monsters outgrow LR habits.
- **Log nothing, remember everything:** you do not need a notebook — you need the habit of reviewing fights in your head while the quest reward screen loads.

Note

Wave 1's mods (Part 2) may add mechanics that change these rules — weapons, moves, even monsters. When the game and this chapter disagree, the mod cards in Part 2 are the authority.

5 Wave 2 — Warden of the Quarry

5.1 Warden of the Quarry

Wave 2 — Warden of the Quarry

*The quarry's heart is aflame. The afflicted rise from its deepest tiers, and the **risen elders** — the quarry's oldest names, dragons the village only whispers about — walk the peaks again, crowned in crimson light.*

You are the warden now. The rookie who took the oath, the expedition hunter who learned to read the hunt — you have been given the highest tier of the quarry and told: keep it. The anomaly investigations are your patrols, the risen elders your inspections, and the endgame grind is not a grind at all — it is the quarry's final lesson, repeated until it is instinct.

*Wardens do not get stronger. They get **unbreakable**.*

5.1.1 Wave 2 Goals

- Clear the Sunbreak story into the true endgame: **Anomaly Investigations** and their escalating ladder.
- Face the **risen elders** and the quarry's final challenges.
- Learn **Qurio Crafting** deep: turn your favorite weapon into a masterpiece.
- Build for every matchup: damage sets, comfort sets, and everything between.
- Leave the quarry as a hunter who can fight **any** monster on its own terms.

5.2 The Endgame Path

The Sunbreak story is the prologue. The endgame is a ladder, and knowing the ladder keeps you sane while you climb it.

5.2.1 Anomaly Investigations

After the story, **Anomaly Investigations** open up: quests against afflicted monsters with a level and reward tier that scales with your progress.

- **Levels:** investigations are leveled; higher levels mean harder monsters and better materials. Your investigation list slowly escalates — complete higher-level quests to unlock more.
- **Materials:** investigation rewards are the currency of the endgame — they fund Qurio Crafting and the final gear tiers.
- **Curating:** you can delete and re-roll investigations; keep the ones with favorable maps, monsters, and rewards for farming.

Tip

Do not hoard low-level investigations forever. Climb the ladder — higher-level rewards are strictly better, and the game stops feeding you progress if you stop climbing.

5.2.2 The Risen Elders

The apex of the ladder: **risen** versions of the elder dragons. They are the hardest monsters in the base expansion, and their materials build the strongest gear.

- Expect genuine walls. Re-read Wave 1's **Reading Monsters** loop; these fights demand it.

- Bring matchup-specific builds — element, resistances, and the right comfort skills.
- The risen fights are also the best **practice** in the game: master one and every lesser monster feels slow.

5.2.3 Special Quests & the Final Challenges

Beyond the standard ladder sit the special investigations and hazard quests — the deliberately overtuned versions. Treat them as optional mastery goals: they exist to be **beaten once**, not farmed forever.

5.2.4 Qurio Crafting, Deep

Wave 1 introduced augments; the endgame is where they matter:

- Plan augment **slots** before you roll: some augments add slots, some add skills, some add raw stats. Your final weapon is an assembly of budgeted bonuses.
- Farm the specific afflicted materials each augment type demands — this is the real use for the investigation ladder.
- Reroll patiently: the augment pool is random, but the **budget** is deterministic. Know what you can afford before you spend.

5.2.5 Layered Everything

By endgame, fashion is free:

- **Layered armor** — any look on any build.
- **Layered weapons** — the same for weapons, unlocked through the endgame quests.
- This is the point where the “ugly but optimal” compromise dies: build optimal, look however you want.

5.2.6 A Sane Order of Operations

1. Clear the story into investigations.
2. Climb investigation levels; bank anomaly materials.
3. Unlock and defeat the risen elders as they appear.
4. Augment your main weapons; build elemental sets as materials allow.
5. Chase layered gear and special quests as your personal finish line.

II 5.3 Buildcraft at the Endgame

Wave 1 taught you to spend skills. Endgame buildcraft is about **assembling** — several complete loadouts, each for a job.

5.3.1 The Loadout Library

Maintain four archetypes and adapt them per matchup:

- **Damage set** — Weakness Exploit + affinity + attack; for fights you know cold.
- **Comfort set** — Evade Window, Divine Blessing, Stun Resistance; for new monsters and long sessions.
- **Elemental set** — the right element at high value, for monsters with glaring weaknesses.
- **Support set** — for multiplayer: buffs, healing, wide-range item sharing (see **Hunt Etiquette**). Each gets a save slot in your equipment box. Adjust per hunt, not from scratch.

5.3.2 The Endgame Priorities

- **Affinity first.** Critical skills scale with everything else; the damage floor rises with them.
- **Then raw/element, then utility.** Once your crits are consistent, flat attack and elemental values compound.

- **Slots are king.** MR armor with generous slots beats slightly-better skills with none — slots accept any skill you need for the matchup.
- **Never skip the comfort core** in new fights. A set that lets you stay in the fight deals more damage than a set that carts you.

5.3.3 Augments & Talismans: The Long Game

- Your **talisman** defines the build's skeleton: roll with whichever melding recipe targets your weapon family, and let the talisman's skills dictate which armor pieces to swap.
- Augments close the last gaps: +1 skill here, +1 slot there. Spend them last, on the weapon you are sure about.
- Accept that some builds wait for a talisman you do not own yet. Play the best version now; upgrade the set when luck lands.

5.3.4 Reading Your Own Build

Before each hunt, ask three questions:

1. **Can I survive this monster's enrage?** — if no, add comfort.
2. **Am I hitting its weak spot?** — if yes, add damage; if no, fix positioning, not gear.
3. **Does this set exist for this fight, or am I forcing it?** — a wrong element is a 10-minute drag; swapping sets takes one minute.

Tip

Endgame buildcraft is a feedback loop: fight, audit, adjust. The build that never changes is the build that stopped improving — and the monsters you face next will notice.

II 5.4 Hunt Etiquette — The Warden's Manners

Multiplayer is where the endgame lives, and multiplayer runs on courtesy. None of this is enforced — that is why it matters.

5.4.1 Before the Hunt

- **Be ready before you post or join:** eat dango, restock, set your loadout. Nobody should wait at camp for your inventory.
- **Match the quest:** joining a specific fight means bringing its matchup — element, consumables, and a build you can actually play.
- **Host's rules win:** the host decides capture vs kill, target order, and pace. Follow the host's lead; if you disagree, host your own quest.

5.4.2 During the Hunt

- **Don't flinch your team.** Wide attacks stagger teammates; position away from your party or slot **Flinch Free**-style skills if your weapon scatters.
- **Wake-ups:** if the monster falls asleep, whoever has the biggest single hit does the wake-up. Everyone else waits, then unloads.
- **Mounts and rides:** when someone triggers a ride, stop attacking the ridden monster — let the rider slam it into walls and monsters for the team's free damage window.
- **Share the tail:** severing parts gives everyone carve chances — but the carves are individual; no need to race, and no one can steal another hunter's carve.
- **Carting happens:** if you cart, apologize, restock, and come back focused. Shaming a teammate helps nothing and loses hunts.

5.4.3 After the Hunt

- **Rewards are individual:** every hunter gets their own reward pool — nothing is taken from anyone. Be generous in spirit, not defensive over loot.
- **Keep the lobby moving:** return to camp quickly, post the next quest or say your goodbyes. Dead air in a lobby is a slow drain on everyone.
- **Add the good ones:** hunters who communicate, carry their weight, and don't rage are the endgame's real rare drops — friend them.

Warning

In anomaly investigations, **host's quest = host's rules**, full stop: the host's investigation levels and materials are on the line. Do not kill a monster the host signaled they want captured, and never push a quest to higher difficulty than the host wants.

5.5 The Warden's Checklist

A living endgame checklist. Work top to bottom; loop the bottom rows whenever a session needs direction.

5.5.1 Short-Term (per session)

- ☐ Eat dango for the fight ahead.
- ☐ Restock + loadout check (mega potions, whetstone, matchup items).
- ☐ Confirm the investigation list has a level you can climb.
- ☐ Check Meowcenaries / Argosy routes are still useful.
- ☐ One new monster read: which attack did you misjudge last time?

5.5.2 Medium-Term (per rank tier)

- ☐ Armor upgraded to tier cap (spheres spent, not hoarded).
- ☐ Main weapon augmented with the next affordable tier.
- ☐ Comfort core still adequate for the current monster tier.
- ☐ Talisman melding running — materials spent, not banked.
- ☐ At least one elemental set drafted for the current big weakness.

5.5.3 Long-Term (the quarry's final lessons)

- ☐ All risen elders defeated at least once.
- ☐ One weapon fully augmented to your satisfaction.
- ☐ Layered armor + weapon set that looks like **you**.
- ☐ A support set built and actually played in multiplayer.
- ☐ Special/hazard quests: the quarry's hardest tiers, beaten for the story of it.

5.5.4 When in Doubt

- Hitting a wall? It is **armor upgrades, element matching, or a tell you are not reading** — never “keep grinding the same thing.”
- Bored? Switch weapons for a session. The quarry does not care how you hunt it, only that you do.
- Burnt out? Stop. The quarry will still be here tomorrow; the resentment won't survive the break.

Note

The endgame is a marathon by design. The warden who finishes is not the one who played the most — it is the one who played **varied, deliberately, and without grinding the joy out of it**.

6 Glossary

I 6.1 Glossary

Terms are grouped by area. Definitions describe the vanilla game as played in Wave 0; Wave 1–2 mods may adjust specifics — the mod cards in Part 2 are the authority where they do.

6.1.1 Hunting Basics

Hunter Rank (HR): The base game's progression rank, earned through Hub quests. Rising HR unlocks quests, monsters, and gear tiers.

Master Rank (MR): Sunbreak's progression tier above HR — harder monsters, MR-only gear, and the expansion's systems.

Quest: A self-contained hunt or gathering task with a timer, a fail condition (usually three faints), and rewards.

Urgent quest: A story-gating quest that unlocks the next star tier when cleared.

Subquest: An optional side checklist running alongside your quest — clear it for bonus rewards.

Village quests: Single-player story quests set in Kamura; the base game's tutorial-campaign.

Hub quests: Multiplayer-scaled quests from the Gathering Hub; where HR progression lives.

Event quests: Special quests with unique rewards, distributed via the game's event quest system.

Faint / Cart: To die in a quest and be carried back to camp. Three carts fail the quest.

Carve: To harvest materials from a slain monster's body (usually three carves).

Capture: Ending a hunt with a trap + tranq bombs on a weakened monster — faster and often more rewarding than a kill.

Trap (shock / pitfall): An item that immobilizes a monster briefly — required for capture, useful for free damage.

Tranq bomb: The bomb used to put a trapped, weakened monster to sleep for capture.

Part break: Destroying a monster's breakable part (head, tail, claws) — staggers it and yields extra rewards.

Tail sever: Cutting off a monster's tail with cutting damage — removes tail attacks and grants a carve.

Hit zone: A body part's damage modifier. Weak spots (often the head) take noticeably more damage.

Limping: The weakened walking state of a near-death monster — your cue to finish or capture.

Skull icon: The minimap indicator that a monster is capturable — appears once your tracking level is high enough.

6.1.2 Combat

Wirebug: Rise's grappling insect — the tool for leaps, wirefalls, and silkbind attacks.

Wirefall: Pressing the wirebug action while knocked down to recover instantly.

Silkbind attack: A weapon's special wirebug move, on a cooldown.

Switch Skill: An alternate move for a weapon slot, unlocked through quests and requests.

Switch Skill Swap (Scroll): Sunbreak's two-loadout system — swap between Red and Blue scrolls mid-hunt.

Great Wirebug: A fixed field point that launches you across the map.

Wyvern ride: The mounted state where you briefly control a monster and slam it into walls or other monsters.

Mounting damage: The hidden meter built by aerial/wirebug attacks that triggers the wyvern ride.

Blight: A debuff applied by elemental attacks (fire, water, thunder, ice) — cured with nullberries.

Status (poison / paralysis / sleep / blast): Monster-applicable effects with buildup meters; each proc delivers its effect.

Stun: The knocked-out state from repeated blunt head hits — you are defenseless while stunned.

Affinity: Critical hit chance; critical hits deal extra damage.

Sharpness: Melee weapon durability, restored with a whetstone. Higher tiers (green, blue, white) deal more damage.

Element: A weapon's elemental damage type (fire, water, thunder, ice, dragon) — matched against monster weaknesses.

Dango: The canteen meal — stat boosts plus a food skill before every hunt.

6.1.3 Gear & Progression

Smithy: The village workshop where weapons, armor, decorations, and buddy gear are forged and upgraded.

Forge / Upgrade: Create a new weapon or advance one along its upgrade tree.

Armor skill: Passive effects granted by armor skill points; they activate at thresholds.

Decoration: A craftable gem socketed into armor's decoration slots to add skills.

Talisman: An equipable charm with random skills, obtained through melding.

Melding: Trading materials at the smithy for random talismans.

Armor sphere: The upgrade material that raises armor defense.

Layered armor: Cosmetic armor that changes appearance without changing stats.

Layered weapon: Sunbreak's cosmetic weapon system — any look on any weapon.

Zenny: The game's money, from quests and selling parts.

Kamura Points: A second currency from gathering and hunting, spent at facilities.

6.1.4 Monsters & Locations

Rampage: The base game's siege defense of Kamura — waves of monsters vs. your walls and weapons.

Afflicted monster: A curio-cursed monster with glowing clusters that must be broken; drops afflicted materials.

Anomaly Investigation: Sunbreak's endgame quest system — leveled investigations against afflicted monsters.

Risen elder: The apex endgame monsters — risen versions of elder dragons, fought late in the ladder.

Elder Dragon: The most powerful monster class — tough fights, strong gear.

Elgado: Sunbreak's hub, home of Master Rank quests and followers.

Kamura Village: The base game's home village.

Subcamp: A campsite in the field that acts as a fast-travel point.

Spiribird: Colored endemic birds that grant temporary stat buffs when collected.

Endemic life: The collectible creatures and hazards of the field — buffs, lures, and environmental tools.

Hunter's Notes: The in-game encyclopedia of monsters, weaknesses, materials, and quests.

Tracking level: The map visibility meter built by collecting monster tracks.

6.1.5 Buddies

Palamute: Your riding dog companion — fast travel and combat support.

Palico: Your support cat companion, with a role defining its behavior (healer, trapper, assist, and more).

Meowcenaries: Buddy expeditions that gather materials on a timer.

Argosy: The trading ship that brings materials or points on schedule.

Cohoot: Your owl scout — check its nest for daily free items.

6.1.6 Sunbreak Systems

Follower: An NPC hunter who joins your quests via Follower Quests — capable AI partners for solo play.

Follower Quest: The quests that unlock and level followers.

Qurio: The crimson curse driving monsters into afflicted states — the expansion's plot and endgame driver.

Qurio Crafting: Weapon augment crafting — spend afflicted materials to roll bonuses (attack, element, slots, skills) onto weapons.

Augment: A Qurio Crafting bonus rolled onto a weapon.

Special Investigation / Hazard quest: The deliberately overtuned endgame quests — optional mastery goals.

6.1.7 Modding & Tools

Mod: A user-made change installed into the game — this list's subject matter (owner-supplied).

Mod card: The entry format used in Part 2: name + URL, dependencies, impact, notes.

Mod manager: Software that installs/toggles mods without manual file editing — this project uses Fluffy Manager 5000.

Fluffy Manager 5000: The mod organizer for this list — see Part 1, Setup.

nativePC: The game-folder overlay directory where Fluffy Manager 5000 installs mod files.

Dependency: A framework or mod another mod requires — install dependencies first.

REFramework: The common script framework many MHR mods depend on — a user-supplied mod in this list when a card lists it.

Load order: The install order of mods; for overlapping files, the lower/earlier entry wins.

Purge mods: The manager's "reset to vanilla" action — uninstalls everything it installed.